Yes -- Chris Squire Signature Bass Tone

Chris Squire is the reason "bright, driven bass" is a genre unto itself.
Rickenbacker 4001 into a split rig -- one side clean, one side cranked -- blended back together.
Pick attack up front, mids pushed for that vocal "growl," top end left wide open.
No scoop. This is not a modern hi-fi bass tone -- it's aggressive and present, sitting almost like a rhythm guitar in the mix.

This patch models that blend using the GP-5's own gain stages (boost + Bass OD, blended) instead of running two physical amps, and adds a second, cleaner CTL state for Yes's more open, arpeggiated passages (intros, builds, sections like "Roundabout"'s intro or "And You and I").

GP-5 Settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB

NR -- Gate
- THRE: 25
- Always on. Light gate -- just enough to clean up hiss from the boost/OD stack without chopping sustain on longer notes.

PRE -- B-Boost (Xotic BB Preamp Overdrive)
- Gain: 60, VOL: 55, Bass: 55, Treble: 65
- **CTL switch.** Off = engaged, On = bypassed.
- This is the "second amp" in Squire's split-signal trick -- a preamp push that adds grit and top-end bite ahead of the OD stage. Off state (growl) runs it engaged; On state (clean) bypasses it entirely so the clean arpeggiated tone stays uncolored.

DST -- Bass OD (bass-specific overdrive with wet/dry blend)
- Gain: 65, Blend: 60, VOL: 60, Bass: 55, Treble: 70
- **CTL switch.** Off = engaged, On = bypassed.
- Blend at 60 (not maxed) keeps the fundamental intact under the drive -- this is the Blend knob doing the job Squire's amp-splitting rig did physically. Treble pushed hard (70) for the aggressive top-end snap that defines the tone. Off = the driven growl (main Yes sound). On = fully clean for open/arpeggiated sections.

AMP/CAB -- NAM SnapTone, slot 55: BrightSVT (always on)
- Built from the `SVT SANS BRIGHT DRIVE (SVT-CL)` NAM and the Hartke410 IR, combined into one snaptone.
- Real Ampeg SVT-CL with the bright drive setting, into the aluminum-cone Hartke410 IR.
- Squire's Rickenbacker clank: bright, driven, trebly. The closest combo in the set.
- Gain: 50, VOL: 60, Bass: 55, Middle: 50, Treble: 70
- Gain 50: the capture as built.
- Bass 55: a touch more low end.
- Middle 50: flat.

- Treble 70: more top end.
- VOL 60: the level Michael set for this snaptone in the 2026-10-02 VOL audit. Trim here if the patch jumps in level against your others.
- Same in both CTL states. AMP and CAB are off in the `.prst`, so nothing stacks on the capture. The N->S block calls slot 55 directly.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1

- 33Hz: +8, 150Hz: -5, 600Hz: +8, 2kHz: +12, 8kHz: +15, VOL: 50
- Always on, both states. This is the Squire signature curve: solid low-end anchor (33Hz), a dip at 150Hz to keep it from getting muddy, then a rising shelf from 600Hz up through 8kHz for the vocal midrange growl and the glassy top-end snap. Not scooped -- Squire's mids are pushed, not cut.

MOD -- B-Chorus (Boss CE-2B for Bass)

- Depth: 20, Rate: 0.8Hz, VOL: 50
- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- Light touch, per the usual MOD rule -- this isn't a drenched chorus tone. Off (growl state) stays dry, all the character comes from the drive. On (clean state) adds a light shimmer under the open/arpeggiated playing, which is where Yes recordings do occasionally use a touch of chorus-y width on cleaner bass parts.

DLY -- Off

Not used. Squire's tone (and Yes's studio bass sound generally) is dry -- no delay character associated with the signature tone.

RVB -- Off

Not used, on either CTL state. Keeping the bass dry and upfront -- any room/hall character on a Yes record comes from the mix, not the bass tone itself.

CTL Summary (GP-5)

- **CTL Off -- Driven Squire growl (main tone):** B-Boost + Bass OD both engaged, no chorus. This is the tone for verses, riffs, and anything with real drive and attack -- the core Yes bass sound.
- **CTL On -- Clean/arpeggiated:** Both gain stages bypassed, light chorus engaged. Use for intros, builds, and open sections where the part needs to breathe and shimmer instead of push.

MIDI toggles

MIDI = True (added 2026-10-12). With no MIDI controller connected, the patch loads and plays exactly as before: CTL and the board work the same. MIDI adds single-block toggles on top.

On MIDI: DST (Bass OD), also on CTL (inverted: on at load).

Sounds:

- **Squire growl** (default). CTL off: B-Boost + Bass OD.
- **Clank.** CTL off, MIDI DST off. The B-Boost alone: the clanky, trebly Rickenbacker preamp edge without the full drive. A middle ground for brighter, busier passages that need bite but not grind.
- **Clean/arpeggiated** (CTL on). Both gain stages off, light chorus.

- **Shared CTL/MIDI blocks:** CTL flips every block assigned to it, whatever state it's in (confirmed by Michael, 2026-10-12). A CTL block you switched by MIDI ends up the opposite of the designed CTL sound. So before pressing CTL, switch it back by MIDI. Changing a block by MIDI *after* pressing CTL is always safe.

Full Pedalboard (signal chain order)

1. Flamma FS-08 Octave -- Bypassed, whole patch.
Squire didn't build his tone around octave layering. Leave the four octave knobs at 0 and Dry at 100 so there's no surprise if the footswitch gets bumped; footswitch stays off throughout.

2. Donner Ultimate Comp -- Engaged, whole patch.
- COMP: 45
- TONE: 55
- LEVEL: 55
- Mode: TREBLE

Sits ahead of everything, evens out pick attack before the drive stages -- Squire played with a pick, hard, and compression is part of keeping that attack consistent without losing note-to-note evenness. TREBLE mode keeps pick attack audible feeding into the darker Ampeg-voiced cab downstream. Runs continuously through both CTL states -- it's gluing dynamics, not part of the growl/clean split.

3. Donner Stylish Fuzz -- Bypassed, whole patch.
Squire's tone is driven, not fuzzed -- a full fuzz wall would bury the note definition his lines depend on. True bypass throughout.

4. Joyo Tidal Wave -- Engaged for CTL Off (growl) sections, bypassed for CTL On (clean) sections.
- Drive: 40
- Blend: 55
- Presence: 60
- Level: 55
- Treble: 60, Middle: 55, Bass: 50
- Mid-Frequency toggle: 500Hz (bass body, not pick-attack cut)
- Bass-Shift toggle: 80Hz (tighter low end -- keeps this from stacking mud with the GP-5's own Bass OD)
- Cab-Sim (DI out): On -- useful if this patch ever gets DI'd to a board or interface
- Ground Lift: Off unless hum shows up in a given room

This is the second grit stage in the "split signal" trick -- physically bypass it for the clean CTL-on sections (step off the footswitch) so nothing colors the open/arpeggiated tone. Engage it for CTL-off growl sections; it stacks with the GP-5's own PRE/DST to build the layered, amp-splitting character of the real rig instead of relying on one gain stage alone.

5. Joyo Narcissus -- Bypassed, whole patch.
The GP-5's own B-Chorus module (CTL On state) is the primary chorus voice for this patch. Per the pedal's own notes, don't run both at once -- stacking two choruses just gets mushy. True bypass throughout.

6. Valeton GP-5 -- as detailed above.

Footswitch Choreography

- **Verses / riffs / driven sections (main Yes tone):** GP-5 CTL off, Tidal Wave engaged. Comp running underneath the whole time. This is the core patch -- reach for this by default.
- **Intros / builds / open arpeggiated sections:** GP-5 CTL on, Tidal Wave bypassed (step off at the same moment you hit CTL). Comp stays on.
- Octave and Fuzz stay bypassed for the entire patch -- this build is two gain stages (PRE boost + Bass OD) plus one grit pedal (Tidal Wave), not a texture pile.